

BROKE WOKE?



Phygital Experience Timeline: 4 weeks Role: Interaction Designer

Turning personal finance into a game where decisions determine your stability.

The Problem Space

3-4%

of Indian teenagers are officially financially literate.

76%

of the adult Indian population is considered financially illiterate.

90%

of families believe kids learn most financial skills outside classroom.

Who are we designing for?

Teenagers / pre-teens aged 10-16

Want independence but don't always understand the consequences of financial decisions.

Why Current Solutions Fail

Traditional Board Games



Gameplay relies on dice rolls & luck
Encourage predatory hoarding & bankrupting peers
Teach zero real-world budgetary cause & effect.

Teen Neo-Banks



Prepaid debit cards tied to real currency
High parental hesitation to grant minors financial independence
Without built-in habits, teens just use cards for fast food

Understanding the User

Primary research

23 teens + 7 parents

Remote interviews

Sentence completion

Key Insights

01 Pre-teens and teens (10-16) **want financial independence**, but parents mostly give money only when needed, which creates **tension between freedom and control**.

02 These teens **understand basic ideas** like saving and needs vs wants, but **struggle with real-world finance**, topics like taxes, interest, and investing feel confusing & advanced.

03 They **rely on memory or piggy banks to track** money, which leads to forgetting spends, running out unexpectedly & feeling stressed.

04 They are strongly **motivated to earn and grow** money, but they engage only when learning feels interactive & game-like rather than lecture-based.

User persona



Handles his own spending but parents set the limits

Gets pocket money from parents + occasional festival cash

Curious about money but has never been taught how it actually works

Owens a smartphone but supervised

Arjun, 14

"I know the terms... but not what they actually mean."

Goals

- Feel independent with money without asking parents for permission every time
- Understand real financial terms (EMI, investing) instead of just memorizing definitions
- Not run out of money without knowing why

Frustrations

- Tracks spending in his head / piggy bank, forgets what he spent & panics when numbers don't add up
- Existing finance apps & videos feel like lectures, will not choose to do for fun
- Caught between wanting freedom and his parents wanting oversight, creates mild annoyance
- Investing/credit/EMI sound "advanced" and intimidating, so he avoids engaging with them at all

Behaviour

- Learns fastest when something feels "real life but fun"
- Plays games with friends already, more likely to learn finance through play than through solo app use
- Will disengage the moment something feels like a lesson

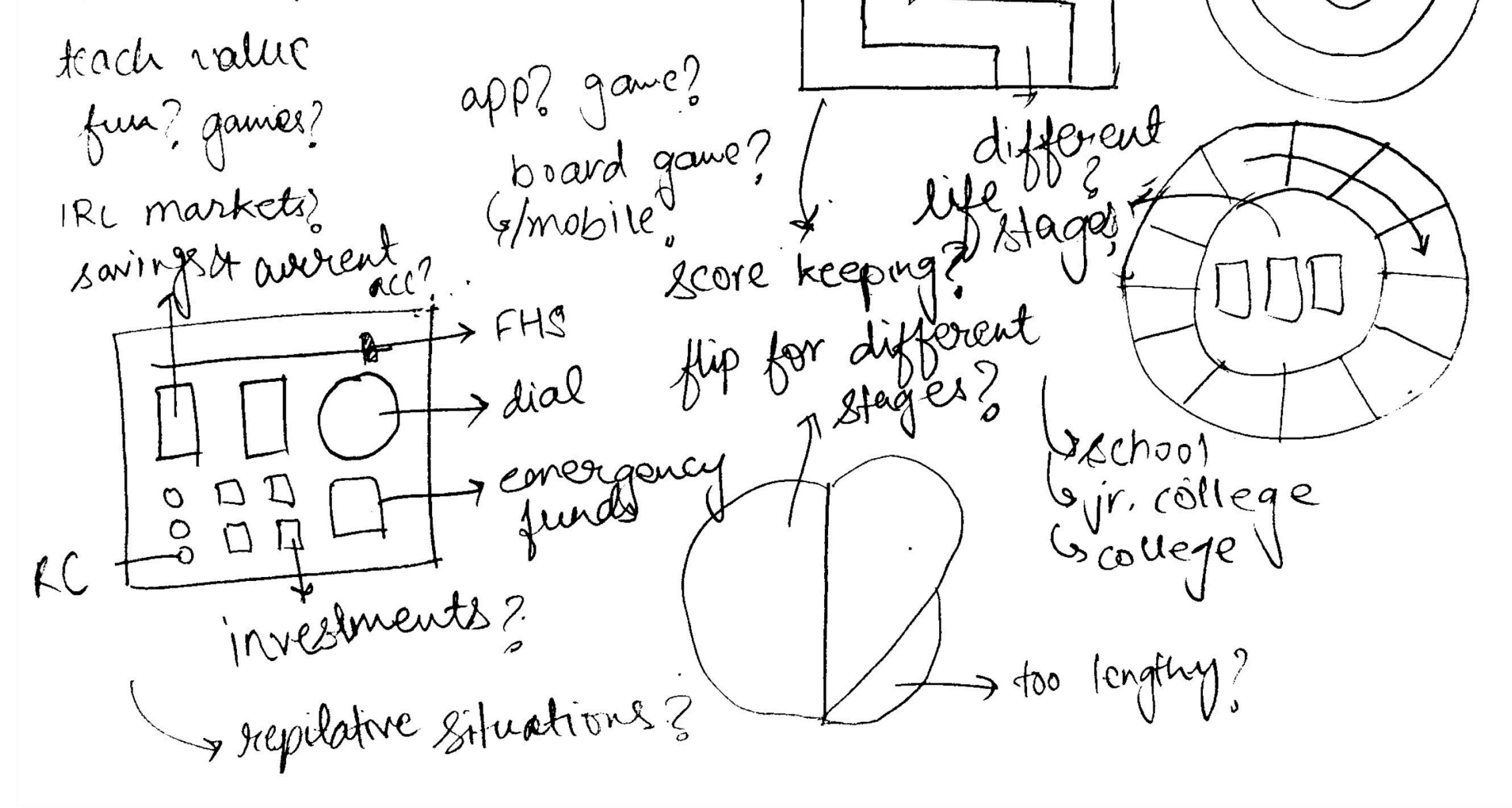
Final Brief

To design a gamified financial learning system that helps teens build real independence, strengthen money tracking habits, and bridge the gap between basic knowledge and real-world earning & growth, while accommodating parental control.

Ideation

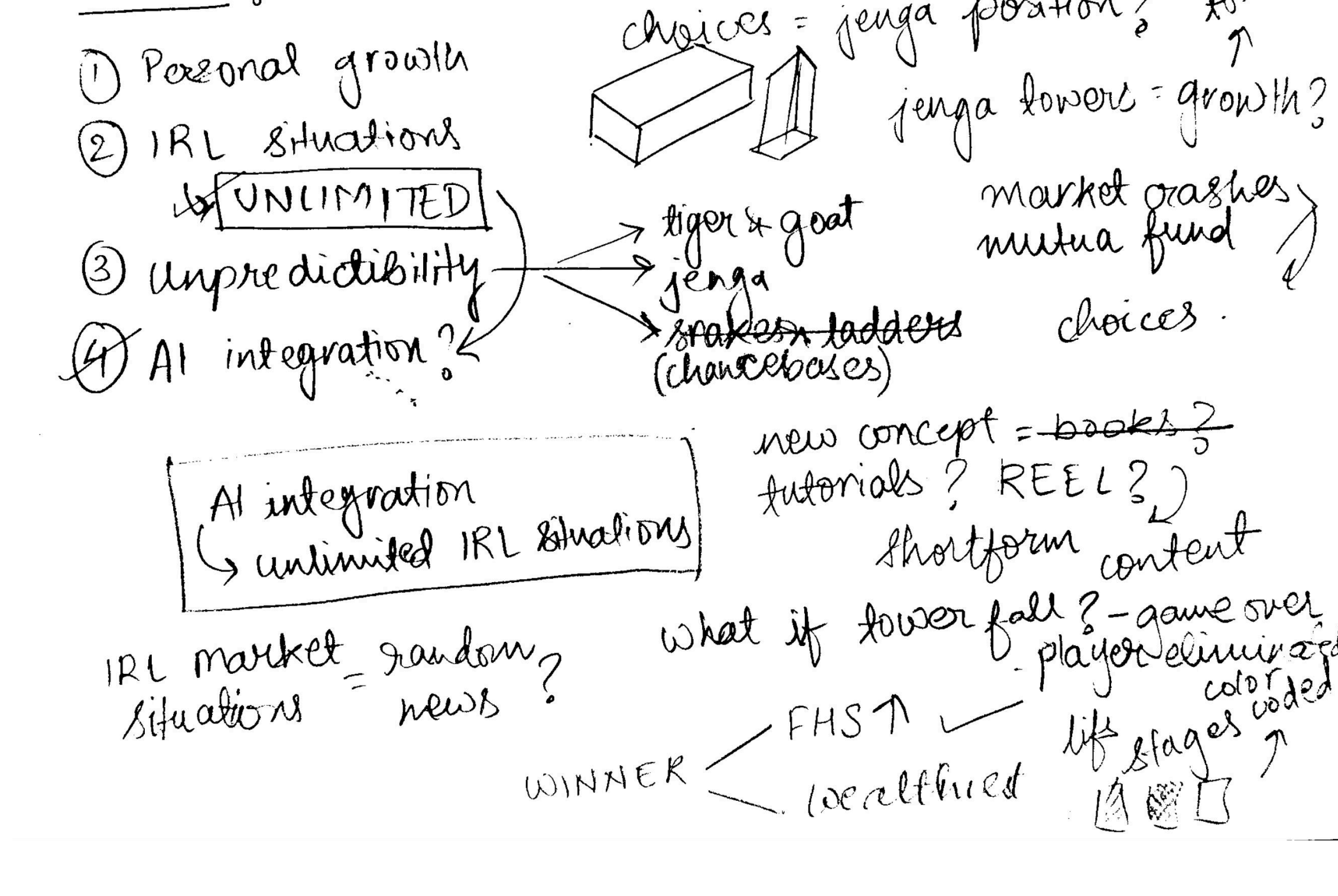
Exploring the Possibilities

We explored various ways to make financial learning more practical, engaging, and consequence-driven.



The Pivot

Our initial board-game direction wasn't solving the problem of repetition and tangible consequence, so we explored a phygital format.

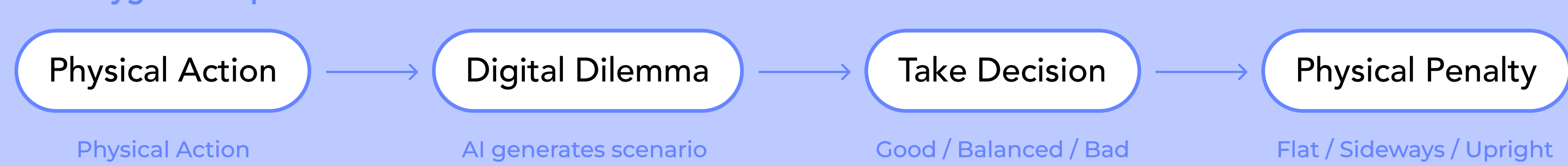


Introducing

BROKE WOKE?

The game translates abstract personal finance into a high-stakes physical simulation. By pairing the physical tension of a wooden block tower with a generative-AI scenario engine, poor financial decisions don't just deduct digital points, they physically destabilize your tower until it collapses

The Phygital Loop



01 Pull a Block
The player pulls a numbered block (e.g., #07) from the tower and inputs the number into the companion app

02 Face the Dilemma
The AI engine generates an age-relevant financial trade-off tailored to that block

03 Consequence Translation
The app translates the financial decision into a mandatory physical placement rule:

Good Financial Decision?



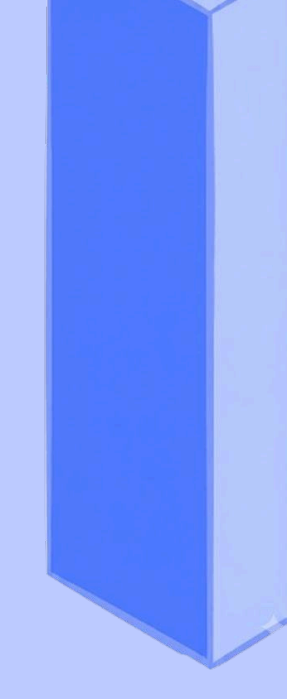
Place the block **FLAT**

Balanced Compromise?



Place the block **SIDEWAYS**

Reckless Choice?

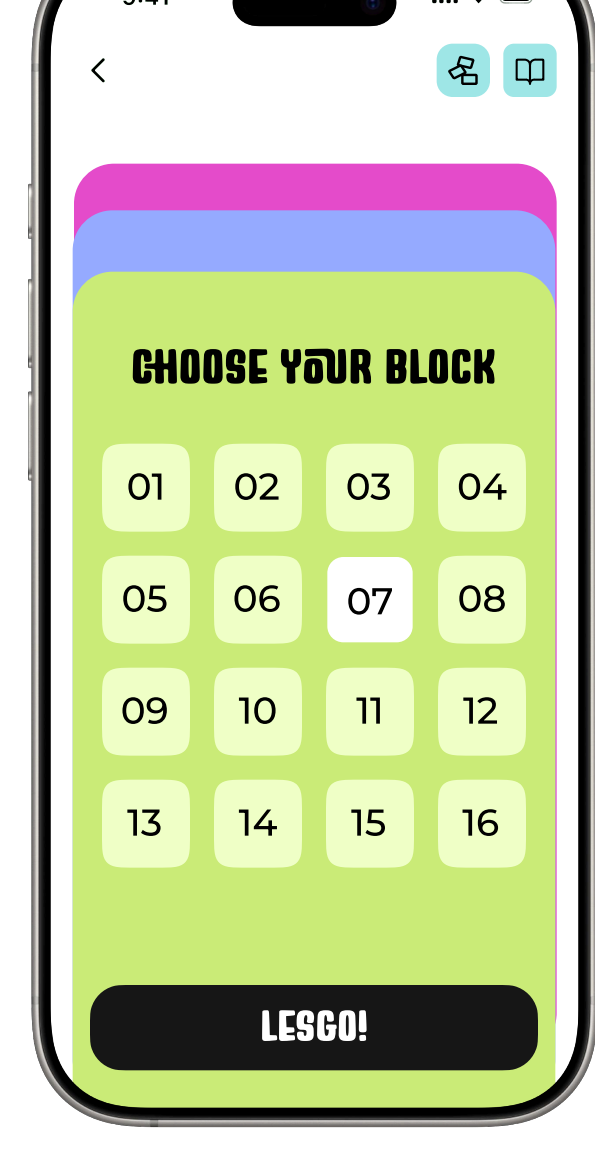


Place the block **UPRIGHT**

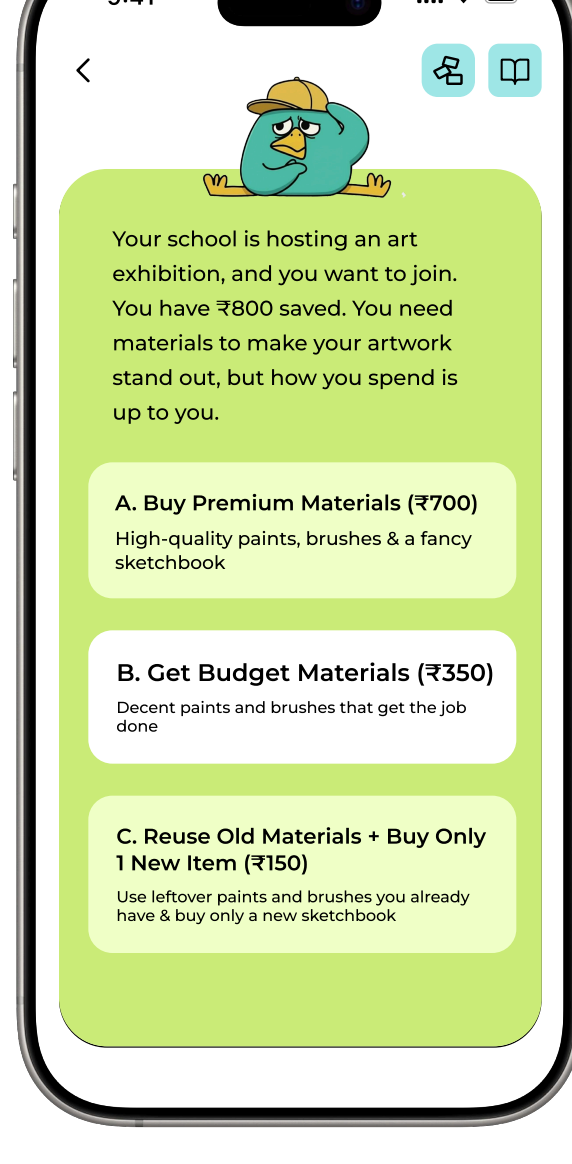
04 Tower Collapse & Endgame
When a player's tower inevitably collapses from accumulated bad decisions, the app calculates everyone's Financial Health Score (FHS) based on block positions & budgetary health. The player with the highest FHS wins!

Key Gameplay Screens

Starting setup: Age 10 & ₹500



Make decisions wisely



AI tells you block position



Scenarios evolve as you age



Deal with plots affecting all players



FHS Reveal

